

Participant Information Sheet

Usability Evaluation of an AI-based Email Phishing Detection System.

Invitation to research

You are invited to take part in a research study. I am Aihaam Zargar and I am a postgraduate student at Manchester Metropolitan University. I am studying for an MSc in Cyber Security. I am carrying out this research as part of my degree and am supervised by Safiullah Khan. This study is not externally funded. Please read the information below carefully and ask me if anything is unclear.

Why have I been invited?

You have been invited because you are a fellow student at Manchester Metropolitan University who uses email and can provide feedback on the system. I am looking for approximately 5 to 10 participants, all students at the University.

Do I have to take part?

No. Taking part in this study is entirely voluntary.

What will I be asked to do?

You will be asked to use a prototype software interface that detects phishing emails. You will interact with the interface using a set of sample emails that I provide, you will not use your own email account at any point. After using the interface, you will be asked to complete a short questionnaire about your experience.

Are there any risks if I participate?

There are no risks in taking part in this study.

Are there any advantages if I participate?

There are no direct rewards for taking part. However, your feedback will help contribute to research on protecting people from phishing attacks.

Informed consent

When you agree to participate, you will need to confirm your consent before you begin by completing a consent form. Your responses are anonymous, so it will be impossible to pull your data back after submitting it. There won't be any recordings or photos taken during the study.

What information about me will you collect and why?

I will only collect your responses to the usability questionnaire which includes your System Usability Scale ratings and any additional comments you might write. I will not collect your name, email address, or any other information that could identify you. This anonymous feedback is all that is needed to figure out how usable the interface is.

How will my information be stored and how will you look after it?

Your information will stay anonymous. It will not have anything that identifies you like your name or any other detail. The responses will be stored securely within my Manchester Metropolitan University OneDrive account. No recordings or samples will be collected.

How will you use my information?

I'll analyse the anonymous responses to evaluate the system's usability. The results will be reported in an aggregated, anonymous form, ensuring no one can be identified in the outputs.

Will my data be sent anywhere else, or shared with other people or organisations?

Your data will stay anonymous and won't be shared or used for marketing. It'll be seen only by my supervisor and me for this project. Microsoft Forms will be used for the anonymous questionnaire. Responses are kept within Manchester Metropolitan University's systems and don't leave the UK.

When will you destroy my information?

The anonymous research data will be retained until the completion and assessment of the MSc dissertation and then for the period required by the University's research data retention and disposal schedule, after which it will be securely deleted.

Data Protection Law

Data protection legislation requires that we state the 'legal basis' for processing information about you. In the case of research, this is 'a task in the public interest.' If we use more

sensitive information about you, such as information about your health, religion, or ethnicity (called ‘special category’ information), our basis lies in research in the public interest. Manchester Metropolitan is the Controller for this information and is responsible for looking after your data and using it in line with the requirements of the data protection legislation applicable in the UK.

You have the right to make choices about your information under the data protection legislation, such as the right of access and the right to object, although in some circumstances these rights are not absolute. If you have any questions, or would like to exercise these rights, please contact the researcher or the University Data Protection Officer using the details below.

You can stop being a part of the study at any time, without giving a reason. You can ask us to delete your data at any time, but it might not always be possible. If you ask us to delete information before you submit your questionnaire response, we will make sure this is done. If you ask us to delete data after this point, we might not be able to. If your data is anonymised, we will not be able to withdraw it, because we will not know which data is yours.

What will happen to the results of the research study?

The results will be submitted as part of my dissertation at Manchester Metropolitan University. The findings may also be used in other academic research.

Who do I contact if I have concerns about this study or I wish to complain?

Researcher – Aihaam Zargar

Email – 25949742@stu.mmu.ac.uk

Supervisor – Safiullah Khan

Email - Safiullah.Khan@mmu.ac.uk

Manchester Metropolitan Data Protection Officer our Data Protection Officer can be contacted using the dataprotection@mmu.ac.uk e-mail address, by calling +44 (0)7584 330586 or in writing to: Data Protection Officer, Legal & Governance, Ormond Building, Lower Ormond Street, Manchester, M15 6BX

UK Information Commissioner’s Office

You have the right to complain directly to the Information Commissioner’s Office if you would like to complain about how we process your personal data:

<https://ico.org.uk/global/contact-us/>

THANK YOU FOR CONSIDERING PARTICIPATING IN THIS PROJECT